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**The role of digitalization of human resources in employee loyalty –
Qualitative study of a sample of compagnies in the industrial area of Akbou –
Province of Bejaia**

دور رقمنة الموارد البشرية في ولاء الموظفين

- دراسة نوعية لعينة من الشركات في منطقة النشاط الصناعي أقبو- ولاية بجاية

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Abstract:

The objective of this paper is to determine the role of the digital transformation of human resources in the retention and loyalty of employees of companies in the ZAC industrial zone of Taheracht of Akbou -Wilaya of Bejaia. The results of the qualitative study show that HR digitalization makes it possible to transform manual workflows into automated process, improve collaboration and internal communication, collect and analyze data to make decisions based on information relevant and to adopt a more agile and flexible approach to manage your human resource in order to retain it.

Keywords: Digitalization, Human Resources, Loyalty Human Resources

الملخص:

الهدف من هذه الورقة البحثية هو تحديد دور التحول الرقمي للموارد البشرية في الحفاظ وولاء موظفي الشركات في المنطقة الصناعية تحراشت بأقبو ولاية بجاية، تظهر نتائج الدراسة النوعية أن رقمنة الموارد البشرية تجعل من الممكن تحويل سير العمل اليدوي إلى عمليات آلية، وتحسين التعاون والتواصل الداخلي، وجمع البيانات وتحليلها لاتخاذ القرارات بناءً على المعلومات ذات الصلة واعتماد طرق أكثر مرونة لإدارة الموارد البشرية بهدف الحفاظ على ولائها. الكلمات المفتاحية: الرقمنة، الموارد البشرية، ولاء الموارد البشرية.

1. INTRODUCTION

In fact, humanity has experienced unprecedented economic development, with five major technological innovations, for more than three centuries (Cazals, 2018). Besides, the latest breakthrough, the one of the New Information and Communication Technologies (NICTs), is unfolding at twice the pace of the first industrial revolution, given that new technologies are rapidly expanding in all sectors of activity (IT, telecommunications, Internet, etc.). Faced with these rapid and complex developments, companies are finding themselves at a higher level of competition, complexity and uncertainty than before.

With the aim of surviving and ensuring their longevity, companies need to improve their operational efficiency, optimise processes, strengthen decision-making, improve the customer experience, foster innovation and stimulate business growth, all of which can be guaranteed by digital transformation within companies. According to (Baudoin, Diard, & Benabid, 2019), it stands for a process that aims to transform a tool, business, object or process into computer code in order to replace it and make it more efficient. Further, it has an

extreme and violent impact on all generations and all areas of activity, thanks to access to information and behavioural changes.

Unquestionably, this digital transformation refers to the process of adopting and integrating digital technologies into a company's various functions and processes. Likewise, it can affect all aspects of the business, including production, logistics, marketing, sales, customer service, data management, knowledge management, human resources and the like.

In human resources, digitization refers to the application of digital technologies to automate, optimise and improve processes and practices pertaining to human resources management within an organisation. Nowadays, the human resources function plays an important role in a company's digital transformation (Peretti, 2010), thanks to the advantages offered by the same to managers, such as the loyalty making of human resources.

In actual fact, according to (Baudoin, Diard, & Benabid, 2019), digitalisation can play an important role in loyalty making of human resources through improving communication between employees within

companies and through providing a degree of work flexibility thanks to employees working remotely.

In this context, we formulated the main question of this study:

How does the digitalization of human resources improve employee loyalty and commitment to the company?

From this main question, other secondary questions arise:

- *What are the benefits of digital transformation of human resources?*
- *What are the benefits of HR digitalization for loyalty making of employee?*

The structure of our problem is based on a main hypothesis, formulated as follows:

Certainly, the human resources digitalization represents a lever for making loyalty of employee by improving the employee experience and enabling HR professionals to make more informed decisions thanks to data analysis, as it encourages the automation of administrative tasks and makes it easier to adapt to technological developments and to the new needs of the company and its employees, as well.

The methodology followed in the course of this work is represented by an analytical method, which begins with a literature search, which gave us an insight into the concept of digitizing human resources. Then, we carried out a qualitative study that enabled us to answer the main question posed through this study.

2. Conceptual Framework

2.1. The world is being transformed by new technologies

Over the last twenty years or so, information and communication technologies or ICTs (e.g. mobile phones, the Internet) have invaded our daily lives and have become an integral, or almost integral, part of our lives. Among these technologies, there has been a meteoric rise in electronic documents, and more specifically on the Internet and websites.

The starting point for what is generally referred to as the digital revolution was the transition from mechanical and analogue electronic technologies to digital electronic technologies for the domain of storing, transferring and using information.

Indeed, the digital revolution, also known as the third industrial revolution, has shown to be an addition to existing technologies. Moreover, the development of information technology and everything to do with technological components meant that, at the end of the 1950s, digital tools began to be integrated into industrial processes. Hence, by the end of the 1970s, digital technology was already immersed in the economy. Accordingly, this encouraged very sudden changes in economic and social development. On the other hand, the emergence of personal computers, the Internet and smartphones ushered in what is called by some peoples the “information age” (“Digital Revolution”, 2023)

Correspondingly, this revolution has been marked by the innovation of the Web and its evolution, from Web 1.0, which provides access to online content and introduces products to consumers, to Web 2.0, which also enables content to be shared thanks to collaborative platforms and social networks during the period 2000-2009, followed by the evolution towards Web 3.0 in 2010, which connects people and is community and “tribe” oriented, until arriving in 2020 towards Web 4.0, which is oriented towards individual/Object interaction.

In reality, these major technological changes are inevitably generating real economic, sociological and even political upheaval. In other words, the whole of human society is at present being totally transformed by digital technology. Further, the economy, politics, social behaviour and everyday practices are all affected by this transformation.

The world is witnessing transformation by all these technological developments, and by the Internet revolution, as well, which has

given rise to a new economy, defined as follows:

“The new economy concerns all current technical developments which, through their emergence and spread, result in the emergence of new economic behaviours and, thereby, give rise to profound structural changes” (Cazals, 2018).

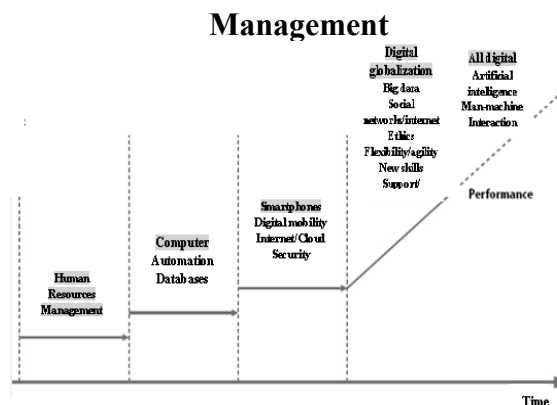
2.2. Human Resources Management in the digital age

Digital is a catch-all term that covers all professions that use the Internet, digital media and mobile phones in their activities, products and services (Portage, 2023).

Definitely, digital refers to all digital technologies, social networks, the Internet and the behaviours associated with their use, mobilised within the organisational framework for performance purposes. The role of Human Resources Manager is to contribute to the successful implementation of new technologies or new practices in order to facilitate people's work and improve their efficiency.

Digitalisation has taken place in several stages, from the mass arrival of computers (automation, databases, etc.), then smartphones (digital mobility, internet, etc.) to the current digital globalisation (big data, social networks, etc.). Besides, the digital era is yet to come (artificial intelligence, human-machine interaction, etc.). The behavioural changes brought about by digital technology (ethics, new skills, etc.) need to be supported by the Human Resources function (Pennaforte, Guignard, & Herbinier, 2018).

Figure (1): Implementation of new technologies in Human Resources



Source: (Pennaforte, Guignard, & Herbinier, 2018)

This fast-paced revolution is forcing companies to rethink their managerial approaches and devise new strategic models adapted to this new situation. Further, this transformation involves rethinking the structure of the organization, its strategy and its processes. The resulting organisational practices are also improved (Warner & Wäger, 2019).

These are supported by the introduction of technologies, in respect such as artificial intelligence, big data, cloud computing and the internet of things. According to (Gregory, 2019) and (Verhoef & Al, 2021), this transformation is creating upheavals that require appropriate strategic responses in organisations.

Similarly, it requires internal changes in the way work is performed and organised, and consequently raises questions about Human Resources Management (HRM) (ebastian & Al, 2017).

2.2.1. Definition of the e-HRM

The digital transformation of the HR function involves, first and foremost, the digital transformation of the HR function itself, in its various processes: recruitment, training, remuneration, skills management, etc. In a first approach, it can therefore be defined as the use of the potential offered by digital technology, through different digital HR solutions (already existing on the market or to be developed) in order to:

- **Enrich the way HR tasks and processes are carried out:** The development and, above all, the

democratisation of virtual simulation in training and recruitment is making it possible, for instance, to offer new types of training (ever closer to reality), as well as new possibilities for enhancing a company's employer brand (virtual tour of premises, presentation of industrial know-how, etc.);

- **Transform the way HR tasks and processes are carried out:** The use of social networks has transformed the way we source candidates by adding a range of communication channels for finding and contacting potential candidates. They complement more traditional sourcing methods (school relations, job fairs, etc.) and have become essential for several years now;

- **Automate the way of carrying out tasks or HR processes:** The RPA (Robotic Process Automation) makes it possible to automate a certain number of tasks at the level of the process of welcoming and integrating employees thanks to the use of algorithms that will automatically launch tasks to be carried out, in respect such as pre-filling administrative documents, launching the creation of e-mail accounts, offering e-learning modules to follow for training purposes

From the three points mentioned above, we can notice that the digital transformation of human resources takes the form of the implementation of one or more solutions for the various HR processes. Besides, these solutions are supported by digital HR projects. In addition, this digital transformation of the HR function can be represented by a portfolio of digital HR projects, each of which involves the use of one or more digital HR solutions¹.

¹ A digital HR solution is a set of hardware and/or software enabling one or more tasks in one or more HR processes to be carried out. Examples of digital HR solutions include a virtual simulation solution (filming and editing software, cameras, virtual reality headsets), an Human Resources Information System "HRIS", a recruitment site (job board), an LMS, and software for producing e-learning self-training modules.

From this point of view, the digitalisation of the human resources function can be considered in a more global way and comprises two main axes:

- ✓ The transformation or evolution of the HR function itself, in its various processes, by integrating the potential offered by digital technology. This is the previously mentioned perspective;
- ✓ The HR department's support for the company's transformation, either with or without the integration of digital HR solutions.

In this case, the HR department plays its role as "social architect". There are several aspects to this role (Baudoin, Diard, & Benabid, 2019):

➤ Supporting the transformation of professions, skills, roles, positions and careers: At present, professions and skills are undergoing rapid and unprecedented change. In this respect, a study conducted by the ITM-BS1 HRM Digital Lab demonstrated in 2016 that 86% of responders, out of a representative sample of 1,002 employees questioned, now believe that their job has been transformed by digital technology. Two years later, the same study conducted in 2018 revealed that this percentage exceeded 90%.

➤ Supporting the transformation of work organisation methods: The introduction of teleworking is another example of a partially digitised response to the changing expectations of employees and managers in terms of work organisation.

➤ Supporting changes in management methods: The support that the HR function can provide to a company's managers in changing management methods to encourage creativity and innovation is an example of a non-digitised response to the digitalisation of a company.

➤ Supporting change management initiatives: The knowledge and working

practices of certain HR departments, in the fields of communication and training, can lead them to contribute to supporting change in digital projects unrelated to the HR field (implementation or development of an information system in its entirety, changes in customer relationship management methods, changes in production methods, etc.).

Consequently, the digital transformation of human resources management is taking the form of HR projects, which may or may not include digital solutions, to transform the HR function itself and/or support the company's digital transformations.

These digital solutions have a real transformative dimension for their users: Transformation of work habits, transformation of work organisation, transformation of skills and professions, transformation of uses.

2.2.2. Synthetic overview of digital HR solutions

➤ Digital recruitment

Digital recruitment refers to the use of different digital solutions to carry out, enhance, facilitate and/or optimise the actions carried out during the five main stages of a recruitment process: Defining needs, sourcing, selecting, deciding on and integrating new employees, not forgetting the administrative management involved at every stage.

In fact, these solutions can range from the simple (use of social networks, recruitment websites, etc.) to the more complex in terms of technological structure and implementation, in respect such as the use of an ATS (Applicant Tracking System).

➤ Digital training

Digital training and informal digital learning cover all multimedia teaching methods, thus enabling employees to learn and develop their skills, both in formal and informal ways, during or outside their work activities, and over varying periods of time.

Additionally, these multimedia teaching methods are designed and distributed using digital design tools (Camtasia, Articulate,

Adobe Captivate, Powtoon, Audacity, Canva, etc.) and distribution tools (LMS, Mooc distribution platforms (Fun, SlideShare, Vimeo, Youtube, Ted Talks).

➤ Human Resources Information System "HRIS"

An HRIS is a set of interrelated software components used to manage the various HR processes (recruitment, training, personnel administration, etc.) by storing, processing and distributing the information required for each of these HR processes.

➤ Teleworking

All collaborative solutions enabling remote communications, together with file sharing.

➤ Video protection

All video solutions used to protect people and property.

3. Humain resources loyalty

3.1. Definition

If truth be told, employee or organisational loyalty, which is the goal of all human resource loyalty strategies, is a difficult concept to define (Dutot, 2004).

This difficulty is explained by (Paillé, 2004) by the fact that employee loyalty is very rarely dealt with in specialist human resources management literature.

The etymological origin of the term "loyalty" as explained by (Poulain-Rehm & T, 2006), from the Latin *fidelitas*, close to the words *fides* (faith) and *foedus* (pact, agreement, alliance), refers to the idea of trust, beliefs and shared values. Further, this idea of trust was used by (Dutot, 2004) to define loyalty in the following way: "*the employee's loyalty to the company corresponds to the relationship of trust which unites the employee to his organisation and which is expressed by his resistance to adopting opportunistic behaviour when faced with an external job offer*".

Nonetheless, (Colle, & Bruch, 2006) point out that this definition has the disadvantage of associating loyalty only with a relationship of trust, whereas there can be loyal employees despite the absence of a relationship of trust with their company.

For these authors, loyalty is an attitude and they define it as: *“an attitude in which a person with a strong sense of belonging and a very low propensity to seek out and examine external job offers finds himself”*.

Other authors combine the two approaches to obtain what is known as a mixed approach. This is the case of (Bouda & Hammoutene, 2021) and (Paillé, 2005)), for whom an employee is loyal to his/her organisation *“when he/she can demonstrate significant seniority and a lack of interest in external professional opportunities, but also when he/she adopts a line of conduct in the context of his/her work which favours continuous effort and avoids any act likely to deliberately disrupt the functioning of his/her organisation”*.

3.2. The economic stakes of human resource loyalty

The loyalty making of human resources is a major economic issue for companies, for which several reasons exist:

- Reducing the costs of recruiting and training new employees, (Paillé, 2005) explains that the mobility of efficient and competitive employees generates various costs for the company. These costs are linked to replacing the employee who has left the company: Recruitment costs, selection costs, training costs, apprenticeship costs, etc.
- In their work, (Guerfel-Henda & Guilbert, 2008) have shown that it is less expensive to retain a good employee than to attract a new one, because employee loyalty reduces the rate of turnover, which can lead to instability and a loss of knowledge within the company. By retaining employees, a company can avoid these disruptions and maintain operational continuity.
- Ensure increased productivity, as loyal employees tend to be more productive because they are more familiar with the company, its processes and its culture. Likewise, they are more likely to be fully committed to their work.
- The contribution of loyalty making of human resources to the creation of

sustainable human capital within the company. Loyal employees accumulate skills and knowledge over the years, which can be a valuable asset for the company.

Upon representation of the conceptual framework of this study, we provide explanation for the methodology of the qualitative study hereunder.

4. Methodology and materials

For achievement purpose of the main objective of this study, which is to understand how the use of human resources function digitalization tools within companies helps them to retain their employees, and also to understand the key success factors of these HR solutions, we used a qualitative approach, using semi-directive interviews. This tool is based on the same means of interaction as the non-directive interview. Therefore, it is the most widely used method of gathering information in the social and human sciences.

The sample of companies we selected was initially made up of 25 companies located in the Taharacht industrial Zone, in the municipality of Akbou, Province of Bejaia.

Above and beyond, we tried to take into account the fact that the companies surveyed belong to various sectors of activity, with the inclusion of the most dynamic companies.

The response rate we could obtain was around 80%, which means that the final sample was made up of 20 companies.

With the intention to obtain better quality information, we drew up an interview guide based on a set of questions which, according to the methodology and on average, should be between 5 and 7 questions long (Fragnière & Al, 2013).

All the questions relate firstly to the organisational profile of the company (general information and pertaining to the digital tools used by the companies surveyed), and secondly to the human resources practices used in the digital age to guarantee human resources loyalty.

These interviews were conducted with human resources managers in the target

companies. The average interview lasts between 20 and 30 minutes. With the interviewee's consent, some of the interviews were tape-recorded and then transcribed. In this respect, we tried to address each topic, not to be excessively prescriptive, and to give the interviewee time to express himself.

There are several methods for carrying out this type of analysis. In our study, we opted for thematic content analysis. Further, this method does not require the researcher to process all the data systematically. All the data, but instead focuses on information that is relevant to the themes selected in advance. With the intention of carrying out this crucial stage of our study, we used software suited to this type of data processing. The software is NVivo 11, one of the most widely used software packages in qualitative research

5. Results and discussion

- ❖ The first group of results relates firstly to the first line of questioning, which concerns the organisational profile of companies as follows:
- ✓ The profile of companies according to their sizes demonstrated that among the 20 companies to which we dealt with, 12 companies are of medium size, i.e. a workforce of employees between 50 and 250 individuals. Besides, 05 other companies are small in size whereat the number of employees is between 10 and 49 employees. The rest of the companies, i.e. a number of 03 companies, are very small, with a workforce of less than 10 employees.
- ✓ The digital tools used by these companies are divided between desktop computers, laptops, smartphones and digital tablets. Nonetheless, all the companies use desktops in their activities, while a smaller number use laptops (07 companies), whereat this device is made available to a few managers. In closing, a significant number of companies (16 companies) use smartphones for professional purposes, with only 02 companies making digital tablets

available to some of their employees for use at work.

✓ In relation to the activity and business of the companies, we have tried to understand what type of software they use. This software is divided between: Office applications and management software used by all the companies subject to survey, business software used by 11 companies and ERP packages used by 03 companies, which represents a very small number compared to the composition of our sample of 12 medium-sized companies, being in need of this type of software for effective management and to make appropriate decisions, accordingly.

✓ Another analysis is conducted in relation to the computer networks present at the level of the companies subject to survey, which enables us to determine the channels used by the latter to communicate, whether internally or externally. As a result, all the companies have an Internet network, and for the other computer networks, 07 out of 20 companies use the internal computer network (Intranet), compared with 04 companies which state that they extend their network externally in order to communicate and exchange information with their partners.

✓ With regards to the digital HR solutions, 10 out of 20 companies have used e-recruitment, social networks or professional social networks. As far as online training is concerned, the number of companies offering this type of service to their employees is limited to 03, a solution that is not sufficiently developed even in medium-sized companies.

❖ The second group of results concerns the role of digital HR solutions in retaining employees within the company. However, before explaining how the managers interviewed interpret the role of digital solutions in retaining their employees, we have endeavoured to understand how these managers perceive human resources loyalty, a very broad

concept that has aroused and continues to arouse major interest in human resources research.

The table hereunder illustrates the different references obtained by these different items.

Table (1): Importance of items associated with the concept of human resource loyalty

Theme	So	Refe
Human resources loyalty	20	99
Keeping employees within the company	20	43
Employees want to stay with the company	12	27
Employees do not take the initiative to look for another job	16	28

Source: Prepared based on processing using NVivo 11 Software

This table illustrates that the items chosen to demonstrate the concept of human resources loyalty received a large number of references. The first item associated with this loyalty is represented by employee retention, which received 43 references found in the transcribed discourse of 20 sources, i.e. all the managers interviewed. The second item sums up HR loyalty by the desire of employees to stay with the company, as it received 27 references from 20 different sources, which shows the gap between this item and the first one.

The third and final item, which comes down to the fact that employees do not take the initiative to look for another job, as it received 28 references from 16 sources.

This result is illustrated by the following verbatim: *"Our employees are not looking to leave because they are not interested in changing company and what is entailed therefrom"*. (Interview with S5)

The results above demonstrated that the human resources managers in the sample of companies subject to study have a false perception of the notion of human resources loyalty. Besides, they summarise this important concept as employee retention, whereas human resources loyalty is a relationship of trust that binds the employee

to his/her organisation and is expressed by his/her resistance to adopting opportunistic behaviour when faced with an external job offer.

The verbatims hereunder demonstrate how these managers perceive loyalty: *"Employees are loyal because our company does everything it can to retain them"*. (Interview with S12)

"The company employees are loyal because they know they will not find a better job elsewhere". (Interview with S19)

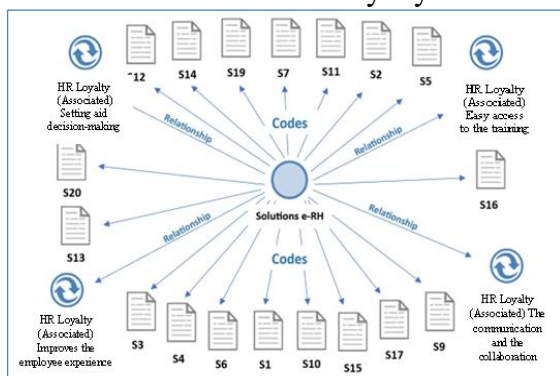
This has alike shown to be clear from the number of sources that cited the first item, which illustrates that responders confuse human resource retention with loyalty making of human resource, given that the latter, represented by the desire to stay with the company, was cited by only 12 sources with 27 references.

- ❖ The interviewees' responses enabled us to summarise the main roles as follows:
- ✓ One of the managerial practices that motivate employees within companies is training, and access to training is facilitated by digitisation through e-learning programmes, learning platforms, skills assessment tools, etc. Therefore, this enables employees to develop their skills and grow professionally within the company. However, when employees have opportunities for development and growth, they are more likely to remain loyal to their employer.
- ✓ In order to retain employees, companies need to make the right decisions at the right time; this can only be achieved with credible information, which is enabled through data analysis, as digitalization makes it possible to collect and analyse HR-related data, in respect such as individual performance, employee satisfaction, turnover rates, etc. In virtue of which, this data can help HR managers make more informed decisions about talent management, employee retention and improving HR practices.
- ✓ Another point was raised by company directors in terms of the contribution of e-HRM was **the communication and collaboration** that is strengthened by

digitization, given that the feeling of involvement and belonging to the company is very important for employee loyalty, which feeling can only be strong with good communication and collaboration, which is made possible by digital technologies that offer online communication and collaboration platforms that enable employees to stay connected, share information and collaborate on projects, regardless of where they work.

- ✓ Digitalization simplifies and automates many resource-related processes, in respect such as holiday management, expense reports, reimbursement of business expenses and performance appraisals, all of which help to improve employee productivity, well-being and in general **improve the employee experience**, which in turn contributes to employee satisfaction and commitment, and fosters their loyalty to the company.

Figure (2): The relationship between digital HR solutions and HR loyalty



Source: Prepared based on the results obtained using NVivo 11 Software

The conclusion we can deduct from this qualitative study is the fact that companies today are faced with the phenomenon of digitizing all their functions, except that this represents a lengthy process that requires key resources and skills.

In this respect, the surveyed companies are in the early stages of digitizing their human resource's function, which is a very simple process, given that the digital tools and software used in the digitization process are

very basic, in addition to the software belonging to this digitization process, as the latter sometimes requires support from the HR department for the adoption and implementation of new digitisation tools and processes.

Whatever the case may be, digital transformation within HR has shown to be difficult to summarise and is evolving fast. Whether it involves personnel administration, payroll management or talent management, it involves the use of professional software, which the companies surveyed do not use. More to the point, this fact represents a real limitation and a brake on digitalization and the positive effects it can have on loyalty making of human resources. In a consequence, we recommend that these companies use digital solutions, in respect such as:

- **Integrated platforms:** Use integrated HRM solutions that bring together administrative management, payroll management and talent management in a single system. These platforms offer a complete overview of employee data;
- **Time and attendance tracking systems:** Automated time tracking solutions enable accurate management of working hours, making payroll and compliance with employment regulations easier;
- **Online payroll software:** These tools automate the calculation of wages, deductions and taxes, thus reducing human error and ensuring compliance with ever-changing tax laws;
- **Portals used for accessing payslips:** Allowing employees to access their payslips and other payroll-related documents online contributes to transparency and employee satisfaction;
- **Online recruitment software:** Facilitate the recruitment process by using platforms that automate the publication of job offers, the pre-selection of candidates and the management of interviews;

- **Learning management systems:** Track and manage e-learning programmes to support employee skills development;
- **Online performance reviews:** Implement automated systems for regular performance reviews, thus helping to identify talent and development needs.

Companies need to position HRM at the heart of digital transformation, and pay greater attention to the social tensions that arise from any sudden and rapid change that impacts jobs and skills, without neglecting support and training for collaborators in such a manner that they can make the tools and new methods of organisation and management their own.

6- Conclusion:

In the digital age, people's habits and behaviour are rapidly changing. Nowadays, digitalization has become essential for all companies, which can no longer choose but must follow this change, which is digitalization, in order to remain competitive in the face of this strategic challenge. Besides, the human resources function, as per illustrated above, has shown to be at the heart of this change, as the digitalization thereof consists of using digital technologies to transform and improve practices, processes and interactions in the field of human resources management.

Amongst the challenges facing companies is to ensure the loyalty of their employees, a concept being supported by the digital transformation of the HR function, given that the latter influences employee loyalty, which in turn depends on a number of factors, in respect such as corporate culture, leadership, career prospects, benefits, etc.

Indeed, the digitalisation of human resources can be a key element in fostering employee loyalty, with the aim of creating a positive employee experience, as the notion of employee experience or candidate experience is nowadays a strategic element in attracting, motivating and retaining employees. Likewise, this digital HR transformation will enhance HR efficiency

and support the organisation's strategic objectives.

Despite the results obtained during this study, some limitations can be raised. In fact, the small size of our sample may present a real limit to the generalisation of these results. Subsequent to which, it would be very interesting to carry out a quantitative study on a larger sample in order to measure the importance of the variables that emerged from the results of this qualitative study.

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